# 2013 Ford C-Max Energi SEL (plug-in hybrid)

$8,730 · 92,931 miles · Dealer · Ridgecrest, CA

Seller: American Dream Auto Sales (Ed), 239 E Ridgecrest Blvd

Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/1FADP5CU8DL522636/2013-ford-c-max-sel-energi-ridgecrest-ca

Report generated October 27, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder










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| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$9,907** | **$536** | **Below average** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 2/5 · 8 recalls · 1 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $8,730.00 |
| Sales tax (9.25%) | $807.52 |
| Dealer doc + filing fees | $125.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $56.74 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $65.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $9,907.27 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $4,907.27 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $98.33 |
| Total interest over the loan | $992.63 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $98.33 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $135.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 38 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $125.00 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $160.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $17.23 |
| Total per month | $535.56 |

Running costs without the loan: **$437/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$15,644** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $49–$112/mo | $70/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $94–$243/mo | $135/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($135/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: typical car. Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Below average (2/5)**

Below average for reliability, excellent for fuel cost. Consumer Reports rates the 2013 C-Max below average. The expensive risks are the hybrid transmission and an aging high-voltage battery, both near this car's mileage.

NHTSA data for this model year: 8 recalls · 1 owner complaints. Most complaints: Tires (1).

**Known issues for this model**

• Hybrid transmission failure (avg ~103k mi, ~$9,100 repair)

• High-voltage battery capacity loss -> shorter EV range

• 12V battery dies often (cheap fix, ~$100)

• 8 recalls for 2013 C-Max (door latches, etc.)

**Check on this car before buying**

• Hybrid-specific inspection: battery health scan, EV range at full charge

• Ask for transmission service/software update records

• Any 'Stop Safely Now' warnings in history?

• Can you charge at home? (worth it only with home charging or lots of city driving)

• Ask about any remaining Ford hybrid-component warranty (CA: 10yr/150k on some hybrid parts)

## Notes

Dealer stock #11287. Gray/black, 2.0L plug-in hybrid. Clean title, ACCIDENT FREE, lease/fleet history.

Price: $8,730, 27% above market avg $6,852 ('Poor buy'). On the lot 156 days and price went UP $180 -> lots of room. Target ~$7,000. Dealer est. out-the-door $9,748.

Best fuel economy on the lot: ~40 city MPG as a hybrid, plus ~20 mi electric per charge if you can plug in at home. Cuts DoorDash gas roughly in half vs a 22 MPG car.

BIG RISK: CarComplaints' #1 issue for 2013 Energi = transmission failure ~103k mi, ~$9,100 avg. This car is at 93k.

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.